

Certainly, the twists and the turnabouts from the Drexel reports had thrown me for a loop. This much I'd figured out: a good economy was good for the stock market, a sluggish economy was bad for the stock market, and vice versa. Also, lower oil prices were bullish for stocks only until higher oil prices became bullish for stocks. Since the stock market "discounted" the things it already knew, while it anticipated the unknown, there was no point in thinking too far ahead. And since current conditions changed so fast, there was no use analyzing them, either. Remember this when you pick up the latest forecast from a brokerage firm, and you discover that their year-long "raging disinflation scenario" has been turned into a "raging inflation scenario" overnight. It couldn't be easy, or else these brokerage firms wouldn't have huge staffs of humans and computers to figure these things out.

In my doubt and confusion from reviewing the forecasts, I thought of Henry Kaufman. If you're going to look into the economic future, why not go straight to the dean of the economic forecasters, the famous spokesman from Salomon Brothers, the man whose speeches make the front page of the *New York Times* and whose opinions move the world markets? Rather than continue to muddle around with secondhand information, I decided to spend some money on another trip to New York. There, I could meet Mr. Kaufman, get his short-term forecast, and then invest whatever I had left in some carefully chosen calls or puts, where one big move could make up for everything.

I was back at my friend's apartment in New York, preparing to contact Mr. Kaufman, when I came across a startling blurb in a magazine: "Astrologer Predicts 88-Point Drop." It referred to Mr. Crawford, the astrologer I'd met in Sacco's coffee shop back in March. Apparently he'd anticipated the recent brutal correction that drove me out of options, out of Prudential-Bache, and out of \$4,000 worth of assets!

A lot of people are going to say: you can't compare Henry Kaufman with Arch Crawford. Mr. Kaufman is the chief economist at Salomon Brothers, and I figured he was paid at least \$1 million a year, plus insurance, for his opinions. Mr. Crawford, I knew, earned considerably less for his. But before I started work on